



WHAT SEX IS YOUR BRAIN?

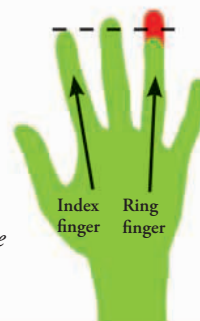
Psychologists think male and female brains tend to have different skills. On average, male brains are better at systemizing skills, such as understanding how machines work. And female brains, on average, tend to be better at empathizing skills, such as understanding people's

feelings. Most people's brains have a mixture of typically male and female skills, with just a leaning to one side or the other. Some girls are perfectly at home fixing bikes or computers, for instance, and some boys have good social skills.



▲ **BIKE TEST** A fun way to find out how male someone's brain might be is to get them to draw a bicycle. Men tend to draw more accurate bikes. Women draw less accurate bikes but might include a rider!

► **FINGER TEST** If your ring finger is longer than your index finger, you're likely to have a male brain. The difference is caused by the level of the male sex hormone testosterone in the body very early in life, when we're still developing inside the womb.



DOES PERSONALITY CHANGE?

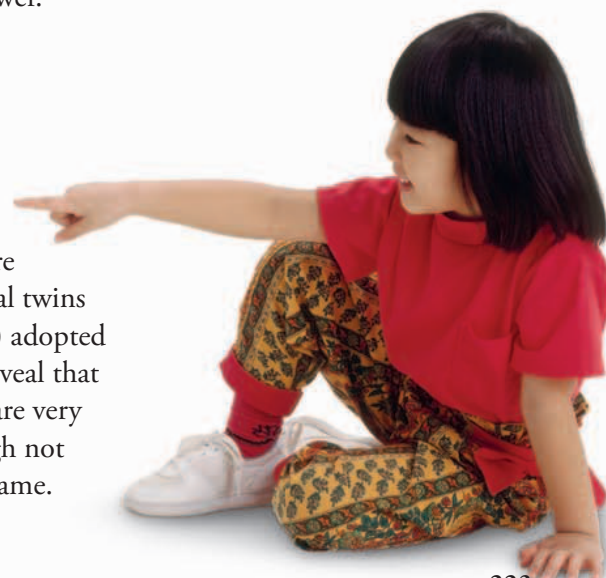
If you think you have a bad personality, don't panic—personality changes during life, even during adulthood. In your 20s and 30s, your levels of agreeableness and conscientiousness will probably go up. In women, neuroticism and extroversion levels go down with age. In men they stay the same, but start off lower.

WOW!

People with “multiple personality disorder” claim to have up to 16 distinct personalities that take turns occupying their body.

IN THE GENES?

Is personality encoded in our genes or molded by our experiences as we grow up? Scientists think that both are important. Studies of identical twins (who have the same genes) adopted into different families reveal that their personalities are very similar, though not exactly the same.



Understanding your own personality can help you choose a career that will suit you.